

IN PROFILE

Henrik Ibsen

Ibsen (1828–1906) was Norway's greatest playwright, renowned for groundbreaking prose dramas, such as *Hedda Gabler*, *A Doll's House*, and *The Master Builder*. Early in his career, he also wrote verse plays, inspired by his country's greatness during the Viking era, and these attracted the attention of contemporary opera composers. But it was *Peer Gynt*, written in 1867, that provided Ibsen's strongest connection with the world of music. He decided that it would benefit from some incidental music and invited Grieg to compose this before the play's stage premiere the following decade.



ILLUSTRATION FROM *PEER GYNT OF THE TROLLS*, BY ARTHUR RACKHAM, 1936.

Piano masterworks

In 1866, Grieg returned to Norway, settling in the capital, where